

Fixed Deposit – Policy & Reference Guide

Grievance redressal, service levels, and glossary

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Fixed Deposit Servicing Knowledge Base

This guide consolidates the grievance redressal policy, service-level turnaround times across request types, and a glossary of FD-related terms. It is intended as a quick reference for customer service teams and for systems that prioritise or escalate depositor emails.

1. Grievance Redressal Policy

Every depositor communication, regardless of channel, is acknowledged and tracked through to resolution. The escalation levels below apply once a request has not been resolved within its standard turnaround time, or where the depositor has written in more than once about the same unresolved issue.

Level	Trigger	Owner	Response TAT
Level 1 – Front-line	First contact on any request	Customer Service Executive	Acknowledge within 24 hours; resolve within the SOP's standard TAT
Level 2 – Escalation	Unresolved past standard TAT, or depositor's second follow-up on the same issue	Team Lead / Senior Executive	Resolve or provide a firm resolution date within 3 working days
Level 3 – Grievance Redressal Officer	Unresolved past Level 2 TAT, or depositor explicitly requests escalation	Grievance Redressal Officer	Resolve or respond with a detailed status within 7 working days
Level 4 – Nodal / Ombudsman referral	Unresolved after Level 3, or depositor indicates intent to approach an external forum	Nodal Officer	As per the applicable regulatory timeline

Principles for handling repeat or multi-issue emails

- Where a single email raises more than one distinct issue, each issue is logged and tracked separately, and the email is not closed until every issue within it is resolved.
- A depositor's reference to having "already written" or "written multiple times" should trigger a check for open or previously closed cases on the account before responding.
- Tone indicating financial distress, urgency (e.g., a wedding or medical need), or dissatisfaction with hold times should be acknowledged directly in the response, separate from the transactional resolution of the request itself.

2. Service Level (TAT) Summary

Consolidated turnaround times for the request types covered in the SOP document, for quick reference.

Request type	Standard TAT
Premature withdrawal	2–3 working days after confirmation
Maturity payout	Same day, up to 2 working days
Auto-renewal reversal	2–3 working days after confirmation
Interest / payout delay	3 working days from logging
KYC update	1 day (contact details); up to 5 days (address/ID)
TDS certificate (Form 16A)	Immediate to 5 working days

Request type	Standard TAT
NOC issuance	5 working days from confirmed closure
Death claim settlement	10 working days from complete documents
Bank account change	2 working days
Duplicate statement / receipt	2 working days

3. Glossary of Terms

Term	Meaning
Cumulative FD	Interest is compounded over the tenure and paid out as a lump sum along with the principal at maturity.
Non-cumulative FD	Interest is paid out at chosen intervals (monthly, quarterly, half-yearly, or annually) instead of being compounded.
Tenure	The fixed period for which the deposit is booked, after which it matures.
Maturity amount	The total amount payable at the end of the tenure – principal plus accrued interest for cumulative deposits.
Premature withdrawal	Closing the FD before its maturity date, subject to a penalty on the interest rate.
Auto-renewal	Automatic renewal of a matured FD for the same tenure if no instruction is received from the depositor.
TDS	Tax Deducted at Source – tax withheld on interest income above a prescribed threshold and deposited with the tax authorities on the depositor's behalf.
Form 15G / 15H	Self-declaration forms submitted by depositors whose income is below the taxable limit, to avoid TDS deduction (15H is for senior citizens).
Form 16A	The certificate confirming the amount of TDS deducted on interest income in a financial year.
NOC	No-Objection Certificate – confirms that a loan or facility has been fully closed with no outstanding dues.
Nominee	The person designated by the depositor to receive the FD proceeds in the event of the depositor's death.
KYC	Know Your Customer – the identity and address verification documentation required to open and maintain an account.
Sweep-in / Flexi FD	An FD linked to a savings account that automatically moves surplus balance into a deposit, and reverses the sweep if funds are needed.
Bulk deposit	A deposit above a specified high-value threshold, generally priced on a separate, negotiated rate card.